

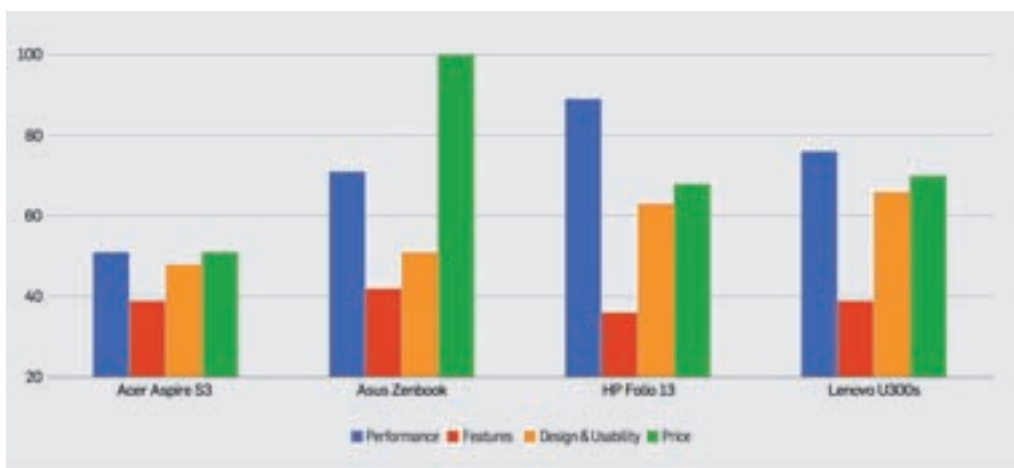
Apple settles lawsuit

Settling the Antennagate lawsuit, Apple will either give affected iPhone 4 users \$15 or a phone cover

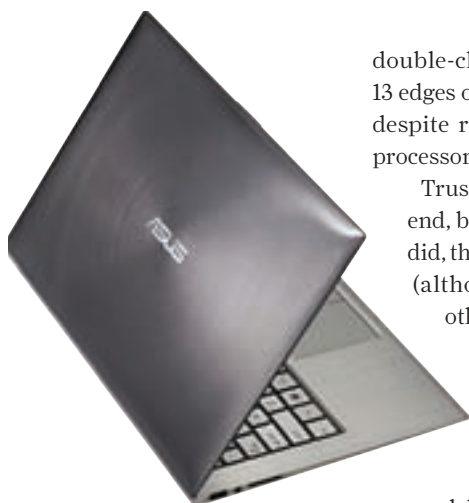
Tetris in 140 bytes

A programmer challenged himself to code a JS under 140 characters. The result? Visit www.140byt.es

Laptop Comparison



Ultrabooks: Comparative analysis through a bar graph. Price index (shown in green) should be as low as possible (ideally); for all other bars (Performance, Feature, Design and Usability) higher is better



Asus Zenbook UX31E

battery tests – Asus fell under by 7 minutes, while HP Folio 13 went over and above that mark by a long shot! Just like Intel claimed, the ultrabooks don't compromise on brute performance despite their anorexic dimensions. Oh, no sir! How could they if all of them are sporting Core i5/Core i7 processors and fast-paced SSDs? HP's Folio 13 won the performance crown in a closely fought contest, with the Asus Zenbook coming in second.

Despite multiple benchmark runs and

double-checking, HP's Folio 13 edges out the Asus Zenbook despite running on a slower processor. Weird, isn't it?

Trust me, it baffled us to no end, but no matter what we did, the scores didn't change (although logic dictated otherwise). This can be partly explained by the fact that our performance score is arrived at by adding CPU and battery results, two crucial components that have a huge bearing on the overall output of the machine.

And the Asus Zenbook's battery life is close to four times

lower than the HP Folio 13's, which frankly, for an ultrabook has a pretty amazing battery life. Finally, we gave up and handed the best performer's trophy to the HP Folio 13.

All four ultrabooks and the 11-inch MacBook Air can handle multitasking with various apps, watching HD 1080p flicks, music and day-to-day apps with ease.

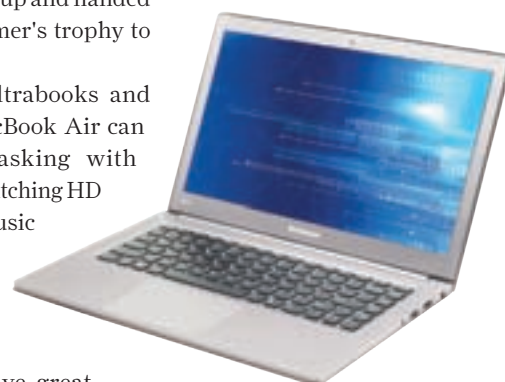
These ultrabooks don't have great depth in onboard audio – whether it's but they are okay for personal entertainment. No doubt, as more manufacturers launch ultrabooks in the coming months, refinement in quality of user experience and fine-tuning components' output will be high on everyone's agenda. as consumers get more picky.

Winner

The HP Folio 13 is our Best Performer, showcasing great processing power with its CPU-SSD combination, beating most other mainstream, general purpose laptops as well. The only thing it doesn't have is dedicated graphics – none of

the ultrabooks presently have discrete graphics, though. All these ultrabooks challenge the might of Apple's MacBook Air in design, features and performance in varying degrees, and some actually manage to successfully beat it – especially the Asus Zenbook UX31E and the HP Folio 13.

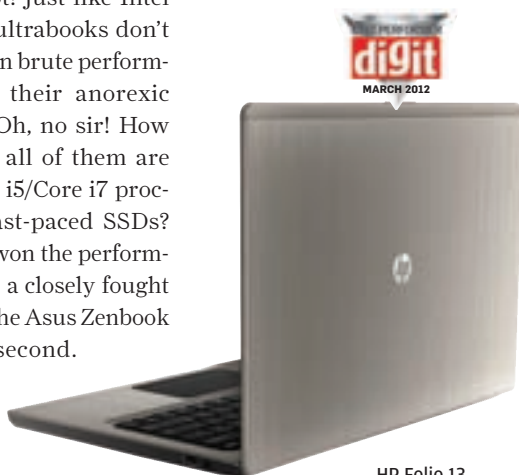
Currently, the argument that ultrabooks will be like MacBook Airs and more affordable than the Apple ultraportable, is a bit flawed. Partly because they are priced in the same range as an Apple MacBook Air (13-inch). In fact, three ultrabooks featured in this test are currently more expensive than the absolute entry level 11-inch MacBook Air that retails for Rs. 56,900.



Lenovo IdeaPad U300s

As Intel eventually delivers on its promise and more manufacturers flood the market with ultrabooks, expect prices to fall. Until that happens, the most important premise, of ultrabooks challenging the MacBook Air successfully, will just fall apart – before the challenge has even begun, in a manner of speaking. For now, we have our fingers firmly crossed.

Only time will tell how successful ultrabooks will be, but for now they look like an exciting new genre of laptops to look forward to. **td**



HP Folio 13